Yarra Valley Water

2030 Strategy

2020 – 2030

Creating a brighter future

Our purpose

To support the health and wellbeing of our customers and create a brighter future for communities and the natural environment.

Contents

Acknowledgement of Country

Message from the Managing Director

Our drivers for change

Strategic and operating context

Our 2030 Strategy

Our values

Honouring and healing Country

Transforming around the customer

Helping communities thrive

Leading for our environmental future

Enabling high performance

Acknowledgement of Traditional Custodians

Yarra Valley Water proudly acknowledges the Traditional Owners/Custodians of the land, water and skies on which we rely and operate. We pay our deepest respects to their Elders past and present.

We acknowledge the continued cultural, social and spiritual connections that First Nations peoples have with Country, and recognise and value their care and protection provided by Traditional Owners/Custodians over thousands of generations. We also recognise and value the continuing rich cultures and contribution of First Nations people to the Victorian community.

Language statement

We recognise the diversity of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples living in Victoria.

We have used the term 'First Nations peoples' to include all peoples of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander descent who are living in Victoria.

The use of the words 'our' and 'we' throughout this document refers to Yarra Valley Water.

Acknowledgement of Country
Message from the Managing Director
Our drivers for change
Strategic and operating context
Our 2030 Strategy
Our values
Honouring and healing Country
Transforming around the customer
Helping communities thrive
Leading for our environmental future
Enabling high performance

Message from the Managing Director

At Yarra Valley Water we're striving to create a brighter future for communities and the natural environment.

We proudly provide essential water and sewerage services to more than 2 million Victorians every day and our customers consistently rank us highly for trust, satisfaction, value for money and reputation.

Working from this solid foundation, and driven by 21st century challenges, we're shifting gear to tackle the big issues and opportunities facing Melbourne and the broader community.

Our innovative approach is driven by our customers, who we work with through an extensive and ongoing engagement process. This includes working directly with customer-led citizens' juries to co-design service provision to ensure it best meets the needs of the customers and communities we serve.

We also value our relationships with key stakeholders who help guide and inform our approach.

We'll continue working with government, community and industry partners to focus our efforts on the things that matter most.

Our 2030 Strategy sets the direction we need for the years ahead. It's centred around our purpose, and commits us to achieving bold ambitions that will support the health and wellbeing of our customers and help create a brighter future for our communities and the natural environment. It describes who we are, what we stand for, how we interact and what we need to focus on to perform at our best.

To track our progress towards achieving our purpose and meeting our strategic outcomes, we've developed a range of measures and targets. Our targets guide us to prioritise our work and align our efforts to make a positive difference.

Our approach will evolve to keep pace with change. We'll continually revisit our outcomes, measures and targets, adapting them to meet the shifting needs and expectations of our customers and stakeholders.

By working together with our customers, community, partners and stakeholders we can achieve great things. As one team, with one plan, we look forward to doing just that.

Pat McCafferty
Managing Director

Contents

Acknowledgement of Country

Message from the Managing Director

Our drivers for change

Strategic and operating context

Our 2030 Strategy

Our values

Honouring and healing Country

Transforming around the customer

Helping communities thrive

Leading for our environmental future

Enabling high performance

Our drivers for change

Melbourne is growing but also facing challenges like climate change, environmental degradation, and social inequality – all put pressure on our way of life.

And with rapid digital transformation, customer expectations are higher than ever.

We need new thinking and aligned action to tackle the uncertainties of the future, including:

Climate change

Horrific bushfires and devastating storms and floods in recent years have highlighted the reality of climate change and its impact. It's expected to worsen, with droughts, floods, fires, and other extreme weather events threatening our water and food security and health.

Population growth

Melbourne is expected to be home to more than 7 million people by 2046. While this means more customers for us, it also puts extra strain on water security. We will need to invest significantly and plan effectively to deliver the essential infrastructure needed to support this growth.

Social inequality

Various factors contribute to growing social inequality. This includes challenges posed by a rapidly aging population, unaffordable housing, diminished job security, and vulnerability to the effects of climate change. The COVID-19 pandemic exposed system frailties and inequalities and reshaped the global economy and society.

Financial vulnerability

The pandemic and subsequent rising cost of living have normalised the experience of vulnerability, highlighting that it can happen to anyone. It's also reinforced the responsibility of organisations and individuals to take a long-term and strategic approach to respond to this reality.

Maintaining public trust

The latest Trust in Public Services Annual Report (2022) reveals that Australians' trust in public services increased significantly during the pandemic. Trust has remained steady since and above pre-pandemic levels. Organisations need to be transparent and involve customers more closely in decision-making to maintain trust.

Evolving customer expectations

Many of our customers expect more than just a safe and reliable water supply.

They want us to work in a socially and environmentally responsible way.
As digital services mature our customers increasingly expect easier, faster, individualised experiences.

Technological disruption

Artificial intelligence, smart devices, the Internet of Things (IoT), automation and augmented reality are just some of the innovations likely to impact the water industry this decade. Challenges include the increasing incidence of cyber-attacks and ensuring the security and privacy of customer and business information.

Environmental degradation

As cities grow to accommodate more people, we are losing natural systems and the plants and animals they support. At the same time, pollutants including microplastics, chemical contaminants, and antibiotic-resistant bacteria are ending up in our waterways.

Contents

Acknowledgement of Country

Message from the Managing Director

Our drivers for change

Strategic and operating context

Our 2030 Strategy

Our values

Honouring and healing Country

Transforming around the customer

Helping communities thrive

Leading for our environmental future

Enabling high performance

Our strategic context

Our purpose is to support the health and wellbeing of customers and create a brighter future for communities and the natural environment.

Our approach goes beyond our core work providing clean water and sewerage services. This includes a focus on diversity and inclusion, looking after people experiencing vulnerability, and developing industry-leading initiatives to create our own clean green energy, reduce waste and restore habitats.

We are committed to the United Nations Global Compact and work to advance the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). We've embedded the SDGs in our 2030 Strategy to provide a global context for how our activities contribute to a more sustainable and liveable future.

Through our 2023-28 price submission, we've made 6 commitments that our customers tell us are important now and in the future:

- Safe and pleasant drinking water
- Reliable water and sewerage services
- Timely response and repair
- Service that meets everyone's needs
- Saving water for the future
- Looking after our natural environment.

We are also guided by the Victorian Government's Letter of Expectations, which focuses on:

- Climate change and environment
- Customer and community outcomes
- Water for Aboriginal cultural, spiritual, and economic values and support economic inclusion in the water sector
- Recognising recreational values
- Resilient and liveable cities and towns
- Leadership, diversity, and culture
- Performance and financial sustainability
- Compliance and enforcement.

The priority policy areas, customer commitments and Sustainable Development Goals are all embedded in our 2030 Strategy. Our approach evolves as the needs and expectations of our customers and stakeholders change.

Government policy direction

Priority policy areas

- Climate change and environment
- Customer and community outcomes
- Performance and financial sustainability
- Deliver water for Aboriginal cultural, spiritual and economic values and economic inclusion in support the water sector
- Recognise recreational values
- Resilient and liveable cities and towns
- Leadership, diversity and culture
- Compliance and enforcement

Customer commitments 2023-28

Caring for Country philosophy for all our decisions and actions

Services we provide

- Safe and pleasant drinking water
- Reliable water and sewerage services
- Timely response and repair
- Service that meets everyone's needs

Actions for the future

- Saving water for the future
- Looking after our natural environment

Sustainable Development Goals

Contents

Acknowledgement of Country

Message from the Managing Director

Our drivers for change

Strategic and operating context

Our 2030 Strategy

Our values

Honouring and healing Country

Transforming around the customer

Helping communities thrive

Leading for our environmental future

Enabling high performance

Our 2030 Strategy

Our 2030 Strategy sets the direction for the years ahead.
It gives voice to our customers who inspire us to deliver what matters.
With optimism, we're proudly working towards a brighter future.

Our approach will ensure we continue to provide essential water and sewerage services while also helping to build a more sustainable, vibrant, and connected community.

Yarra Valley Water exists to support the health and well-being of customers, our community, and the natural environment. We use innovative and sustainable practices to keep water flowing to 2 million Victorians who rely on us 24/7 and we work hard to keep bills affordable. Now, as we look to the future, we're striving to do more to help create a healthier, happier, and more prosperous community where no one is left behind.

We're one of Australia's largest water utilities, servicing almost 800,000 homes and more than 59,000 businesses. Our customers enjoy our safe, reliable services every time they turn on the tap or flush the toilet. We work sustainably to protect our precious water supply now and into the future and we're committed to helping communities thrive.

The next decade will bring unprecedented challenges for Melbourne, Australia, and the world. Cost of living pressures, the impact of climate change, population growth, and changing community expectations are just some of the factors that will impact our business to 2030 and beyond.

But with challenge comes opportunity. By delivering our 2030 Strategy, we're confident we can make a real difference over the next 10 years.

Our purpose

At Yarra Valley Water, we're driven by a powerful purpose that brings meaning to our work. Led by this purpose, our 2030 Strategy sets the direction for the years ahead as we work towards a brighter future for our customers, community and environment.

Honouring and healing Country

Our guiding principle is honouring and healing Country. We'll focus on reconciliation and enabling self-determination while expanding our partnerships with Traditional Owners/Custodians and First Nations organisations and businesses. We'll work together to heal Country and embrace a caring for Country philosophy in every decision we make.

Transforming around the customer

Caring for customers is in our DNA and we work hard to earn their trust. We'll build closer relationships with customers, recognise their diverse needs and work to enhance every experience they have with us.

Ongoing digital transformation will allow us to better respond to our customers and ensure we can meet their individual needs and expectations – even as they continue to evolve. We will continue to focus on delivering safe, reliable, and affordable water and sewerage services.

Helping communities thrive

We'll help local communities thrive in a rapidly changing world. That means securing our city's water supply for the future, boosting community prosperity and resilience, and creating healthy public spaces where people can connect.

We'll do this in an inclusive way, to ensure everyone benefits, with ongoing engagement with communities across our service area.

Contents

Acknowledgement of Country

Message from the Managing Director

Our drivers for change

Strategic and operating context

Our 2030 Strategy

Our values

Honouring and healing Country

Transforming around the customer

Helping communities thrive

Leading for our environmental future

Enabling high performance

Our 2030 Strategy (continued)

Leading for our environmental future

And we'll lead for our environment, adopting a regenerative approach so we leave our part of the planet in a better state than it is now. That means reducing our resource use, going beyond zero carbon, and improving the health and resilience of ecosystems in our service area. We're excited about our important contribution to help build a circular economy for Victoria where resources are maximised, and nothing is wasted.

Enabling high performance: People and culture, safe and well, always efficient and digital enablement

Our strategy is powered by people, partners, processes, systems, and technology. Maintaining our high-performing achievement oriented workplace culture is critical to our success and we'll deliver as one team. We'll pursue all of this within a safe workplace and with sound financial governance.

Our values

Our values form the foundation of our constructive culture and help us to get things done. They define what we stand for, how we show up, and how we interact with each other.

Our organisation is driven by incredibly talented and passionate people who share our values and use them to make a difference every day.

> **Together with our partners we'll help create a brighter future for our customers, communities, and the natural environment.**

Contents

Acknowledgement of Country

Message from the Managing Director

Our drivers for change

Strategic and operating context

Our 2030 Strategy

Our values

Honouring and healing Country

Transforming around the customer

Helping communities thrive

Leading for our environmental future

Enabling high performance

Our purpose and 2030 strategy

Our purpose is to support the health and wellbeing of our customers, and create a brighter future for communities and the natural environment

Our 2030 Strategy

Our Guiding Principle

Honouring and healing Country

Transforming around the customer	Helping communities thrive	Leading for our environmental future
Our outcomes Earned trust and satisfaction Great customer experiences Affordable for all Safe and pleasant drinking water Reliable assets and services Timely response and repair	Our outcomes Secure water future Valued community partner	Our outcomes Beyond zero carbon Towards circular Healthy ecosystems

Our Enablers

People and culture	Safe and well	Always efficient	Digital enablement
Our focus areas Workforce of the future Culture and purpose Performance through potential Diverse, equitable and inclusive workforce	Our focus areas Keeping our people safe at work Enhancing our wellbeing – 'better for being here'	Our focus areas Managing expenditure within regulatory benchmarks Delivering financial efficiencies Financial sustainability	Our focus areas Cyber security Business continuity Leveraging digital for value creation Managing critical business information

Our Values

People first	One team	Deliver what matters	Be brave	Positive impact

Contents

Acknowledgement of Country

Message from the Managing Director

Our drivers for change

Strategic and operating context

Our 2030 Strategy

Our values

Honouring and healing Country

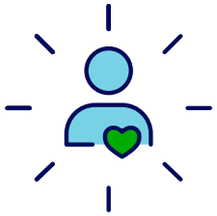
Transforming around the customer

Helping communities thrive

Leading for our environmental future

Enabling high performance

Our values



Our values form the foundation of our constructive culture.

They define what we stand for, how we show up, and how we interact with each other. They capture what makes us great while driving us to grow and evolve – representing both who we are and who we want to be.

At Yarra Valley Water,

Everything starts with putting **People First.**

We work as **One Team.**

We will **Be Brave.**

With clear focus we **Deliver what Matters.**

And together we will have a **Positive Impact:**

for our customers, communities, partners, the natural environment – and each other.

Contents

Acknowledgement of Country

Message from the Managing Director

Our drivers for change

Strategic and operating context

Our 2030 Strategy

Our values

Honouring and healing Country

Transforming around the customer

Helping communities thrive

Leading for our environmental future

Enabling high performance

Honouring and healing Country

Moving forward together.

Our service area always was, and always will be on Aboriginal land. We acknowledge the historic and ongoing harms of colonisation and we are committed to moving forward, together.

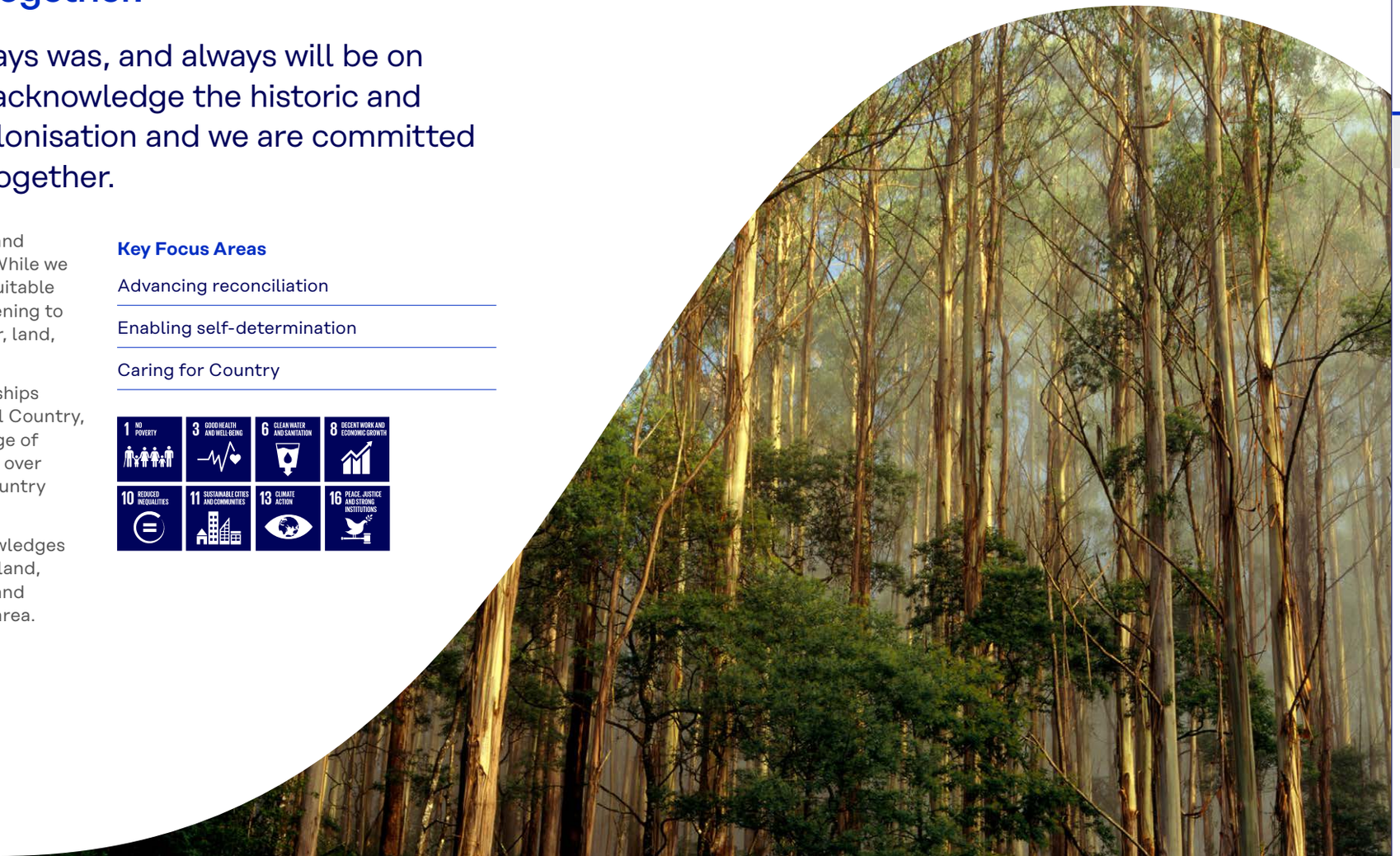
We honour and respect the rights and cultures of First Nations peoples. While we work towards and support their equitable role in the water sector, we are listening to their perspectives and seeing water, land, and skies through their eyes.

Together, through trusted relationships and partnerships, we'll work to heal Country, drawing on the invaluable knowledge of First Nations peoples accumulated over thousands of years in caring for Country and community.

'Country' encompasses and acknowledges the intricate connections between land, waterways, air, sky, people, plants and animals associated with a specific area.

Key Focus Areas

- Advancing reconciliation
- Enabling self-determination
- Caring for Country



Contents

Acknowledgement of Country

Message from the Managing Director

Our drivers for change

Strategic and operating context

Our 2030 Strategy

Our values

Honouring and healing Country

Transforming around the customer

Helping communities thrive

Leading for our environmental future

Enabling high performance

Transforming around the customer

Creating great experiences for customers every day.

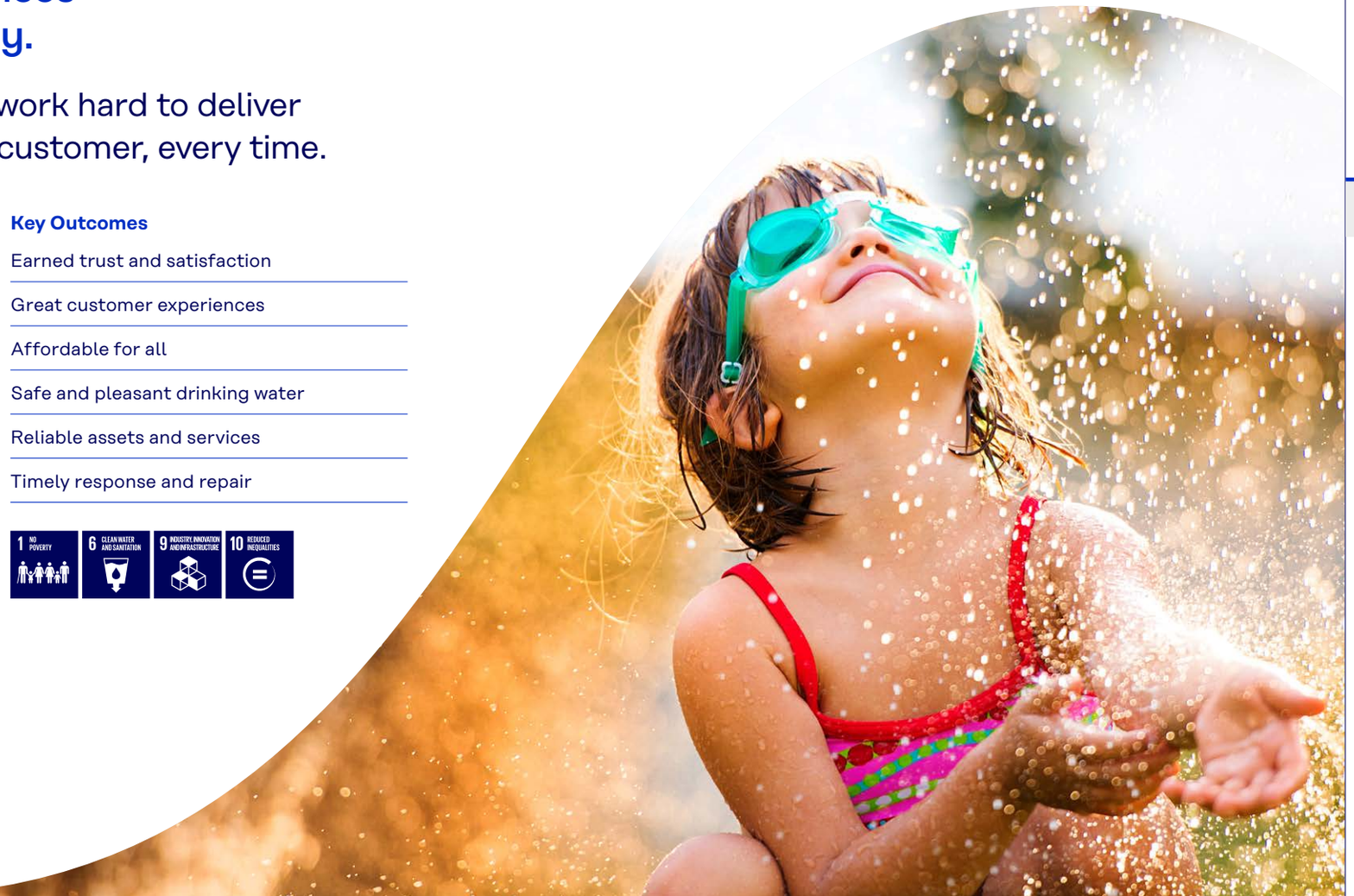
We care for customers and work hard to deliver great experiences for every customer, every time.

In the face of the challenges of this decade, we'll continue to deliver safe, affordable, and reliable services and timely response if something goes wrong.

We will also improve our digital customer experience and accessibility for customers.

Key Outcomes

- Earned trust and satisfaction
- Great customer experiences
- Affordable for all
- Safe and pleasant drinking water
- Reliable assets and services
- Timely response and repair



Contents

Acknowledgement of Country

Message from the Managing Director

Our drivers for change

Strategic and operating context

Our 2030 Strategy

Our values

Honouring and healing Country

Transforming around the customer

Helping communities thrive

Leading for our environmental future

Enabling high performance

Helping communities thrive

Water is essential for life and community wellbeing.

Our customers and partners value our role in helping to shape resilient and prosperous communities and promoting human rights, social inclusion, and equity.

Engaging and connecting communities – listening, learning, and responding – is a crucial part of our strategy.

Relying on rainfall and dams is no longer enough to secure long-term water security for Melbourne.

We strive to ensure Melbourne never experiences severe water restrictions again.

Key Outcomes

Secure water future

Valued community partner

Contents

Acknowledgement of Country
Message from the Managing Director
Our drivers for change
Strategic and operating context
Our 2030 Strategy
Our values
Honouring and healing Country
Transforming around the customer
Helping communities thrive
Leading for our environmental future
Enabling high performance

Leading for our environmental future

We are committed to acting for a cleaner, greener, healthier Melbourne.

We need to shift from a potential future of severe climate change scenarios and nature being degraded, to one where ecosystems and native species thrive.

We will play our part in achieving this by eliminating our carbon emissions, embracing a circular economy, and protecting and restoring ecosystems. We will also work with partners to influence this shift beyond own our operations.

We also rely on a healthy environment to deliver our services and we recognise the need to innovate to adapt to ecological challenges.

Key Outcomes

- Beyond zero carbon
- Towards circular
- Healthy ecosystems

Contents

Acknowledgement of Country

Message from the Managing Director

Our drivers for change

Strategic and operating context

Our 2030 Strategy

Our values

Honouring and healing Country

Transforming around the customer

Helping communities thrive

Leading for our environmental future

Enabling high performance

Enabling high performance

People are at the heart of what we do.

We'll achieve results through our engaged, high performing, achievement oriented workforce, and people-first safety and wellbeing approaches.

We'll harness digital technology to provide great customer and employee experiences, while prioritising always being efficient to deliver an affordable service for all.

Key Focus Areas

- People and culture
- Safe and well
- Always efficient
- Digital enablement

Contents

Acknowledgement of Country

Message from the Managing Director

Our drivers for change

Strategic and operating context

Our 2030 Strategy

Our values

Honouring and healing Country

Transforming around the customer

Helping communities thrive

Leading for our environmental future

Enabling high performance

Yarra Valley Water

At Yarra Valley Water we're on a mission to create a brighter future – and by delivering on our 2030 strategy, we'll get there together.